

Of mice and men



Robert Sovereign-Smith, Editor

Every month, from here on, in the form of Digit TV we're going to give you as much video content as we can, and try and share the knowledge and expertise that we are privileged to receive

At around this time every year, the festival season rolls around. Starting in October and running a little into the new year, these few months see an increase in activity by vendors and manufacturers. Everywhere you go you're bombarded with discounts, special offers, and other catchy and innovative alliterations that all basically say the same thing – buy me.

The consumer electronic and personal technology segment specifically, sees entire product ranges being refreshed, older stock being sold off at rock bottom prices and buzzwords flying about like nobody's business. For the everyday buyer, this amounts to being stuck in a maze of choices, with no clear indication of what's good, what's value for money, and what isn't.

You and I alike, spend the few precious holidays we get with our families at the local electronic mall, gawking at all the goodies, listening to all the sales pitches that every mall employee is only too eager to subject you to, getting more confused by the minute about which <insert product category here> to buy.

So how do we go from feeling like the little white mice that are made to run mazes in labs, to informed customers? Reading and surfing helps, but everything you'll find online is usually outdated in months, and sometimes weeks or days during festival season. All of us can Google for reviews and comparisons, visit sites like thinkdigit.com, or read magazines like Digit for information, but is that all we need?

Although we offer you the best information possible by rigorously testing products, to help you get value from every last Rupee you spend; it's still not enough. As I said last month in this space, we're not as committed to imparting information as we are to sharing knowledge. It's the same reason why today's newspaper is tomorrow's cupboard lining, but this issue of Digit will command a long shelf life in your home.

Over the past few years we've seen video become the desired form of, not just entertainment, but learning as well – the spike in video content online is testament to this. Some of you will have noticed that we've been carrying videos that have been made completely in-house by Digit over the past few months. Although this is still in a teething phase, and know we have a long way to go, we decided to launch "Digit TV". This is another in a long lists of "Firsts" that Digit has done over the years.

For those of you don't remember, Digit's other firsts include the first magazine in India to include DVDs, and later the first to dual-layer; we were

the first tech magazine (in the world, probably) to give away Hollywood blockbusters on DVD, the first to offer a CD magazine, and the first to start including a free book (Fast Track).

Every month, from here on, in the form of Digit TV we're going to give you as much video content as we can, and try and share the knowledge and expertise that we are privileged to receive. Like Digit 3.0, Digit TV will also evolve based on your feedback, so make sure to send us some.

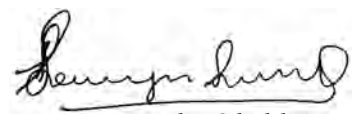
This month, Digit TV is dedicated to buying guides, across multiple categories, to help you get out of the confusing maze and make informed decisions because you actually understand the underlying technology, instead of just parroting what people tell you. Plus, since it's a video DVD, you don't need a PC to view it – just pop it into any DVD player.

We also have a web exclusive, in the form of a PMP test online at thinkdigit.com, so we haven't forgotten our online patrons either.

With three more DVDs (Work, Play and Learn), all of you should have enough multimedia content for every aspect of your life that technology covers. There are a tonne of prizes to be won everyday of October, so make sure to find the contest page inside.

Last month, our career webinar generated a lot of interest, so we're going to make sure you get more of the same from here on – again, details inside.

I want to stress, however, that all of this comes to naught if you don't share feedback with us about the initiatives we're taking. There are two things I'd like to make sure of: one, that we continue to share knowledge, and two that we stay relevant by understanding your needs. So make sure you write in whenever you have something to say. 


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